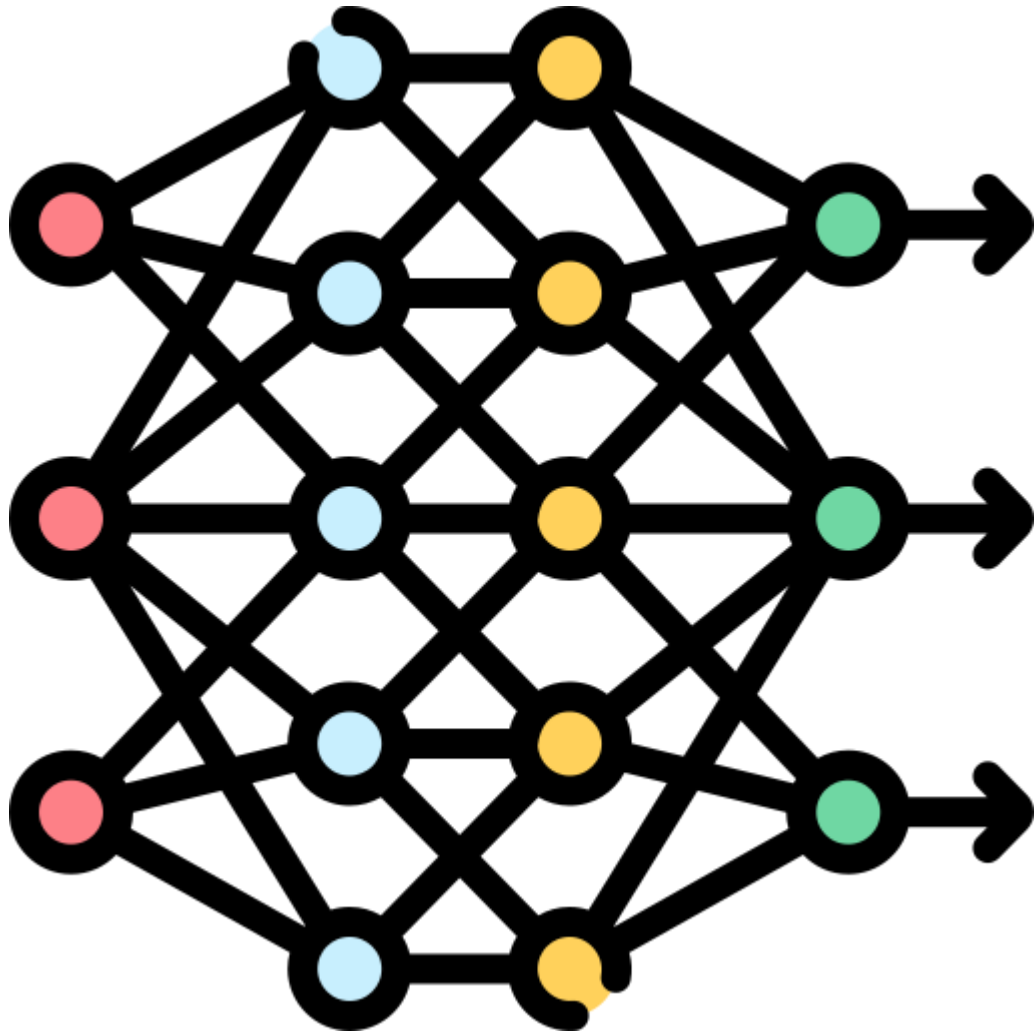




LEARNING

Course instructor:
Dr Shweta Chawak
Assistant Professor
Humanities and Social Sciences
IIT Bombay

Write down one thing you know how to do very well (not academic). How did you learn it?

Discuss:

- Learned by association (one event triggers a response to another)
- Learned by consequence (to seek reward or avoid punishment)
- Learned by watching others (Imitating or observing others)

What is Learning?

- Learning is any relatively permanent change in behavior brought about by experience or practice
- Physical changes occurs in the brain
- Temporary changes or changes due to instinct or maturation are not learning
- Experience is the key feature of learning
- Behavior changes without practice or experience do not qualify as learning



Examples not considered learning:

- X Maturational changes (e.g., crawling, standing, walking at certain ages)
- X Illness or drug-induced temporary changes (e.g., lack of coordination, aggressive behaviour)

Why Do We Need to Study about Learning?

- Learning builds essential skills and knowledge for personal and professional growth
- It helps individuals adapt to change and solve problems effectively
- Learning promotes critical thinking and informed decision-making





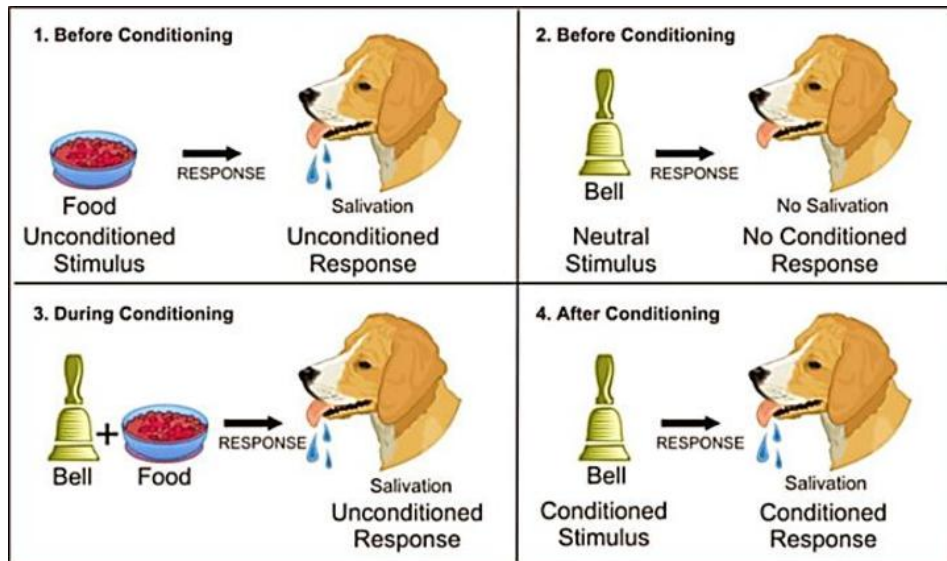
#SorryNotSorry



Theories of Learning: Classical Conditioning

- Ivan Pavlov
- **Reflex:** an involuntary response, one that is not under personal control or choice
- **Stimulus:** any object, event, or experience that causes a *response*, the reaction of an organism
- **Classical conditioning:** learning to make an **involuntary response** to a stimulus other than the original, natural stimulus that normally produces the response

Theories of Learning: Classical Conditioning (cont'd...)



Term	Definition	Example
Unconditioned Stimulus (UCS) 	A naturally occurring stimulus that leads to an involuntary and unlearned response	Food causing salivation in Pavlov's dogs
Unconditioned Response (UCR) 	Involuntary and unlearned response to a naturally occurring or unconditioned stimulus	Salivation in response to food
Neutral Stimulus 	A stimulus that has no effect on the desired response prior to conditioning	No response/no salivation
Conditioned Stimulus (CS) 	A previously neutral stimulus that, after association with the UCS, triggers a learned response	Bell causing salivation after conditioning
Conditioned Response (CR) 	A learned response to a conditioned stimulus	Salivation in response to bell alone

Theories of Learning: Classical Conditioning (cont'd...)

Some principles to consider:

- 1) The conditioned stimulus (CS) must be presented before the unconditioned stimulus (UCS) for conditioning to occur
- 2) The CS and UCS must be presented close together in time, ideally within 5 seconds
- 3) The neutral stimulus must be paired repeatedly with the UCS to create conditioning
- 4) The CS is usually a distinctive stimulus that stands out from other stimuli



Theories of Learning: Classical Conditioning (cont'd...)



Stimulus Generalisation

Responding to a stimulus similar to the original conditioned stimulus

- Different but similar stimulus evoke the same response

Stimulus Discrimination

Learning to respond only to the specific conditioned stimulus, not similar ones

- Different but similar stimulus evoke the same response

Theories of Learning: Classical Conditioning (cont'd...)

Extinction

The weakening or disappearance of a learned response when the unconditioned stimulus or reinforcer is removed

Example: A teen's excitement to check their phone fades if the notification sound rings too often without any new messages

Spontaneous Recovery

The reappearance of a learned response after extinction has occurred

Example: After ignoring phone notifications for a while, a teen suddenly reacts again with excitement to the notification sound





They taught him John Cena song means dinner time...😭



@doppammine

Classical Conditioning: Application

Student Life & Campus

- Notification sound -- anxiety/excitement
- Class bell-- alertness / disengagement

Technology & Digital Behaviour

- App notification: urge to check phone
- Gaming sounds: excitement/arousal
- *Designers use sound, colour, and timing to create learned responses*

Advertising & Consumer Behaviour

- Brand + celebrity / music positive emotion
- Food ads: hunger even when not hungry
- Festival visuals: *Emotion is conditioned to the product.*

Health & Emotions

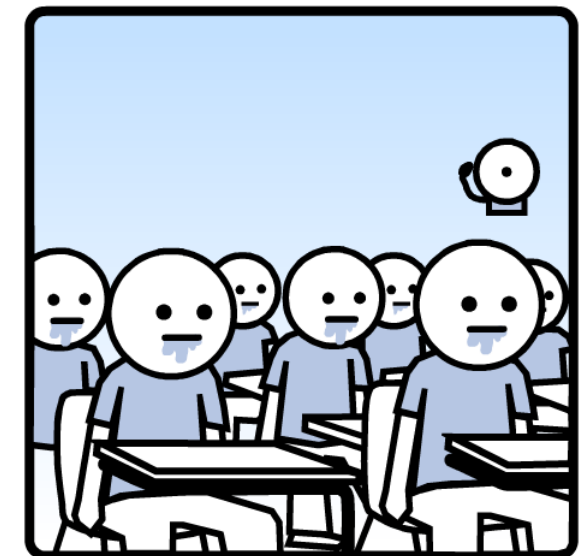
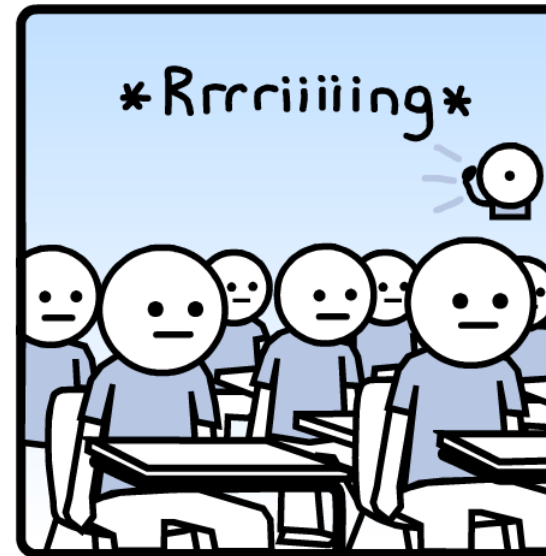
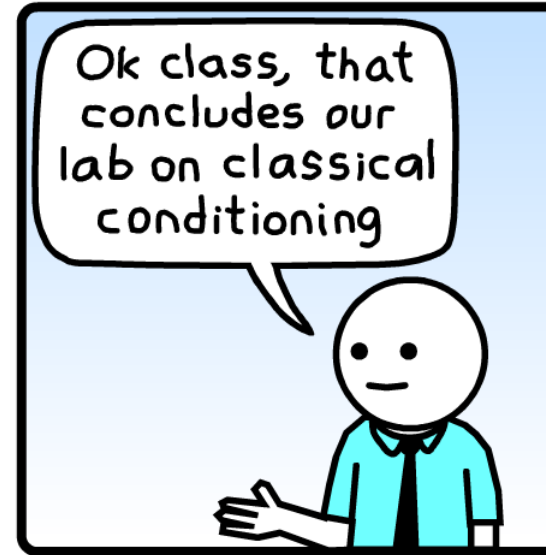
- Hospital smell: fear/anxiety
- White coat: nervousness



If you find yourself cringing at the mere sight of a hypodermic needle, your cringing is a CR to the CS of the needle. The pain of the shot would be the original UCS.

RECAP

- Learned by
 - association (one event triggers a response to another)
 - consequence (to seek reward or avoid punishment)
 - watching others (Imitating or observing others)
- Classical conditioning
 - Unconditioned stimulus
 - Unconditioned Response
 - Neutral Stimulus
 - Conditioned stimulus
 - Conditioned response
- Stimulus Generalisation vs discrimination
- Stimulus Extinction vs spontaneous recovery
- Application of Classical conditioning in everyday life



THEJENKINSCOMIC